

PROJECT DOCUMENTATION

Aura of Nature

Luxury Skincare & Wellness Ecommerce Platform

- What we are building
- Technology stack
- Storefront page structures
- Homepage sections
- Admin & API overview
- Design system & integrations

Table of Contents

- 1. Executive Overview
- 2. What We Are Building
- 3. Brand Positioning & Audience
- 4. Technology Stack
- 5. Monorepo Architecture
- 6. Storefront — Page Structure
- 7. Homepage — Section Map
- 8. Shop & Product Pages
- 9. Cart, Checkout & Account
- 10. Content & Legal Pages
- 11. Admin Panel Structure
- 12. Backend API Surface
- 13. Design System
- 14. Integrations & Environment
- 15. Build Phases & Roadmap
- 16. Local Development

1. Executive Overview

Aura of Nature is a luxury skincare and wellness ecommerce platform focused on botanical and Ayurvedic care. The product delivers a premium editorial shopping experience for consumers, paired with a full admin console and a Node.js API for catalog, orders, payments, and content.

The platform is organized as an npm monorepo with three packages: the customer storefront (client), the operations admin panel (admin), and the Express API (server). All fifteen planned build phases — from design system through SEO and admin completion — are marked complete.

- Brand tagline: Nature Crafted. Science Perfected.
- Primary market: India (international shipping planned)
- Product lines: soaps, face washes, lotions, essential oils, cold-pressed oils, combos

2. What We Are Building

We are building an end-to-end ecommerce experience that feels like luxury hospitality UX applied to organic botanical commerce — cinematic homepage motion, floating chrome, editorial typography — while remaining a fully functional shop with cart, checkout, accounts, and admin operations.

Core product capabilities

- Browse curated collections (skin, body, hair, oils, combos)
- Product detail with gallery, reviews, related products
- Cart, wishlist, coupon-aware checkout
- Payments via Razorpay (online) and Cash on Delivery
- Customer accounts: profile, addresses, orders, wishlist
- Editorial content: blog, about, ingredients, FAQ, store locator
- Admin: products, orders, inventory, coupons, blogs, analytics, media
- SEO: meta tags, JSON-LD, generated sitemap/robots assets

3. Brand Positioning & Audience

Positioning

Small-batch, handcrafted, transparent ingredients. Ayurvedic ritual meets modern formulation. Visual language mixes forest greens, cream grounds, soft gold accents, and display serif typography (Cormorant Garamond) with a clean UI sans (Outfit).

Audience

- Wellness-conscious shoppers seeking natural / Ayurvedic skincare
 - People with sensitive skin who value ingredient transparency
 - Customers who prefer cruelty-free and sustainable packaging cues
 - Currently served for India shipping; international expansion planned
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4. Technology Stack

Storefront (client/)

Layer	
UI framework	React 19 + TypeScript
Build tool	Vite 6
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4 + design tokens
Routing	React Router 7
Data fetching	TanStack Query + Axios
Forms / validation	React Hook Form + Zod
Motion	GSAP, Framer Motion, Lenis smooth scroll
UI extras	Swiper, Lucide icons

Admin (admin/)

Layer	
UI framework	React 19 + TypeScript + Vite
Styling	Tailwind CSS 4
Charts	Recharts

Data / forms

TanStack Query, Axios, Zod

Dev port

5174

API (server/)

Layer

Runtime

Node.js "e 20

Framework

Express 5

Database

MongoDB via Mongoose

Auth

JWT + bcrypt

Payments

Razorpay

Media

Cloudinary + Multer

Email

Nodemailer (SMTP)

Security

Helmet, CORS, rate-limit, compression

5. Monorepo Architecture

Root package name: aura-of-nature. Workspaces: client, admin, server.

- client/ — Customer-facing storefront (@aura/client)
- admin/ — Back-office dashboard (@aura/admin)
- server/ — REST API (@aura/server)

High-level folder map

- client/src/pages — route pages by domain (home, shop, product, cart...)
- client/src/components — ui, layout, home, shop, product, checkout, content

- client/src/contexts — Auth, Cart, Wishlist, Catalog
 - client/src/data — static brand/catalog/content copy
 - admin/src/pages — dashboard domains (orders, products, analytics...)
 - server/src — routes, controllers, models, middleware, services, email templates
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6. Storefront — Page Structure

All storefront routes are defined in `client/src/routes/paths.ts` and registered in `App.tsx`. Pages are lazy-loaded inside `RootLayout` (Header, Footer, Lenis). Auth pages hide site chrome.

Brand & discovery

/	Homepage — full editorial experience
/about	About the brand
/our-story	Brand story narrative
/ingredients	Ingredient philosophy & education

Shop & catalog

/shop	Main shop / all products
/shop/skin-care	Skin care collection
/shop/body-care	Body care collection
/shop/hair-care	Hair care collection
/shop/essential-oils	Essential oils collection
/shop/cold-pressed-oils	Cold-pressed oils collection
/shop/combos	Bundles & combos
/shop/best-sellers	Best sellers
/shop/new-arrivals	New arrivals
/search	Site search results
/product/:slug	Product detail page (PDP)

Commerce flow

/cart	Shopping cart
/checkout	Checkout — shipping & contact
/checkout/payment	Payment (Razorpay / COD)
/order/success	Order confirmation

Customer account (protected)

/account
/account/profile
/account/addresses
/account/wishlist
/account/orders

Account overview
Profile settings
Saved addresses
Wishlist
Order history

Content & support

/blog
/blog/:slug
/faq
/contact
/store-locator

Blog index
Blog article
Frequently asked questions
Contact form
Physical store locator (Maps embed)

Legal

/privacy-policy
/return-policy
/shipping-policy
/terms

Privacy policy
Returns & refunds
Shipping policy
Terms of service

Authentication (guest-only)

/auth/login
/auth/register
/auth/forgot-password
*

Sign in
Create account
Password recovery
404 not found

7. Homepage — Section Map

The homepage (HomePage.tsx) is a single continuous scroll composition. Sections below are the building blocks we ship — each with one primary job (story, proof, commerce, or conversion).

1. Hero

Full-bleed brand statement: Nature Crafted. Science Perfected. Primary CTA into shop.

2. Story

Ritual narrative — small-batch Ayurvedic preparation; link to Our Story.

3. Editorial scroll

Cinematic scroll storytelling / atmosphere.

4. Featured split

Highlighted product or collection split layout.

5. Concerns

Shop by skin / wellness concern.

6. Expectations

What customers can expect from Aura of Nature.

7. Ingredients

Ingredient education teaser.

8. Categories

Collection grid: Skin, Body, Hair, Essential Oils, Cold Pressed Oils.

9. Best sellers

Commerce rail of top products.

10. Philosophy

Brand philosophy statement.

11. Why us

Differentiators (purity, craft, transparency).

12. Ingredient showcase

Deeper visual ingredient feature.

13. Timeline

Brand / craft journey timeline.

14. Reviews

Social proof / testimonials.

15. Instagram

Social / UGC style gallery.

16. Newsletter

Email capture.

17. Manifesto

Closing brand manifesto.

8. Shop & Product Pages

Shop page structure

- Header / breadcrumb for collection context
- Toolbar: sort, filter, view controls
- Filter panel (category, concern, attributes as applicable)
- Product grid of ProductCard components
- Empty / loading / error states

Collection routes (/shop/skin-care, etc.) reuse the shop view with a preselected category. Search uses the same catalog surface with query params.

Product detail (PDP) structure

- Breadcrumb (home !' collection !' product)
- Image gallery
- Product info: title, price, variants / size, add to cart / wishlist
- Tabs: description, ingredients, how to use, shipping notes
- Reviews block
- Related / recommended product rail

9. Cart, Checkout & Account

Cart

- Line items with quantity controls
- Subtotal / estimated totals
- CTA to checkout; continue shopping
- Cart toast feedback on add

Checkout

- Contact & shipping address
- Coupon application
- Order summary sidebar
- Payment step: Razorpay online or COD
- Success page with order reference

Account

- Overview dashboard entry
- Profile editing
- Address book CRUD
- Wishlist management
- Order history list / detail access

10. Content & Legal Pages

- About / Our Story / Ingredients — brand education
 - Blog index + article templates with SEO
 - FAQ accordion (shipping: India only today; international planned)
 - Contact form
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- Store locator with Google Maps embed
- Policy layout shared across privacy, returns, shipping, terms

11. Admin Panel Structure

Admin runs on port 5174. Authenticated shell uses AdminLayout + Sidebar. Routes from admin/src/routes/paths.ts:

/login	Admin login
/	Dashboard overview
/orders	Order management
/orders/:id	Order detail
/products	Product list
/products/new	Create product
/products/:id/edit	Edit product
/categories	Category management
/users	Customer / user management
/coupons	Coupon codes
/inventory	Stock / inventory
/reviews	Review moderation
/blogs	Blog CMS list
/blogs/new · /:id/edit	Blog create / edit
/analytics	Analytics views
/sales	Sales reporting
/media	Media library (Cloudinary)
/settings	Admin settings
/notifications	Notification center

12. Backend API Surface

Express API mounts under /api. Health check: GET /api/health. Primary route groups:

Mount	
/api/auth	Register, login, password, session
/api/users	User profile & admin user ops
/api/products	Catalog CRUD / listing
/api/categories	Category taxonomy
/api/orders	Order create & status
/api/cart	Server cart sync
/api/wishlist	Wishlist items
/api/coupons	Coupon validation
/api/blogs	Blog content
/api/payments	Razorpay order / verify
/api/upload	Media upload !' Cloudinary
/api/admin	Admin aggregates
/api/admin/analytics	Analytics endpoints

When MongoDB is offline in non-production, the server can fall back to in-memory auth/store so admin and local demos still work.

13. Design System

Documented in client/DESIGN.md. Philosophy: luxury hospitality UI (cinematic scale, floating chrome, micro-labels) × organic botanical brand language. Original components — not a third-party template clone.

Color & type tokens

Token	
Display font	Cormorant Garamond
UI sans	Outfit
Cream	#f4efe6
Warm white	#faf8f4
Beige	#e6dccb
Forest	#243528
Olive	#5a6b48
Soft gold	#b8975c
Charcoal	#1a1a18

UI kit (client/src/components/ui)

- Button variants: primary, secondary, ghost, outline, gold, inverse
- MagneticButton, TextLink, Display / Eyebrow / Body typography
- Container / Section editorial spacing; Glass (light/dark)
- Underline Input / Textarea; Badge, Divider, Logo, IconButton
- Layout: floating Header, SiteMenu, Footer, Lenis SmoothScroll

14. Integrations & Environment

Third-party services

- MongoDB / Atlas — primary data store
- Razorpay — online payments (simulated if key missing)
- Cloudinary — product & media assets
- SMTP / Nodemailer — transactional email
- Google Maps — store locator embed

Key environment variables

Package	
client	VITE_API_URL, VITE_SITE_URL, VITE_RAZORPAY_KEY_ID
admin	VITE_API_URL, VITE_SITE_URL
server	PORT, MONGODB_URI, JWT_*, CLIENT_ORIGINS
server	Cloudinary keys, Razorpay keys, SMTP_*

15. Build Phases & Roadmap

Completed phases (1–15):

- 1. Folder structure '✓'
- 2. Design system '✓'
- 3. Authentication '✓'
- 4. Homepage '✓'
- 5. Shop '✓'
- 6. Product '✓'
- 7. Cart '✓'
- 8. Checkout '✓'
- 9. Account dashboard '✓'
- 10. Backend APIs '✓'
- 11. Admin panel '✓'
- 12. Animations polish '✓'
- 13. Optimization & SEO '✓'
- 14. Content pages '✓'
- 15. Admin completion '✓'

Forward-looking notes

- International shipping — mentioned in FAQ as planned
- Ensure payment keys and SMTP are configured for production
- Review/scaffold routes may still need mounting hardening in production deploys

16. Local Development

From the repository root after npm install:

- `npm run dev:server` !' API at `http://localhost:5000`
- `npm run dev:client` !' Shop at `http://localhost:5173`
- `npm run dev:admin` !' Admin at `http://localhost:5174`
- `npm run build` !' production builds for all packages

Dev admin credentials

- Email: `admin@auraofnature.com`
- Password: `Admin1234!`

Credentials auto-create when MongoDB is offline. With MongoDB available, seed via: `npm run seed --workspace=@aura/server`

End of document. Generated for Aura of Nature internal planning and onboarding. For live route constants see `client/src/routes/paths.ts` and `admin/src/routes/paths.ts`.

